

# Problems Technology Solves: Social Worksheet

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## Grade 6 • Worksheet • About 25 minutes

Work with pen and paper. Use color pencils if you like. You do not need a computer or the internet.

**Name:** \_\_\_\_\_

**Grade/Section:** \_\_\_\_\_

**Date:** \_\_\_\_\_

### How to use this worksheet

- Do the parts **in order** from top to bottom.
- Each part has a **time** so you know how long to spend.
- Read every instruction before you write. You can do this on your own.

## Part 1 – What you will learn (about 3 minutes)

**What you will learn:** When communities use technology to solve problems, **people** are affected—not only machines. In this worksheet you will ask **whose problem** gets solved, notice **access** gaps, see how one fix can create **new concerns**, and decide when technology is the **right** choice. You will also practice speaking up with respect.

### Do this:

1. **Name one problem** technology helped you with recently (any tool counts).

2. **Name one problem** technology did **not** fix for someone you know—or made harder.

## Part 2 – Whose problem gets solved? (about 5 minutes)

Designers and leaders choose **which problems** to work on first. A tool that helps one group might not help—or might hurt—another group if their needs were not considered.

**Real-life scenario:** A school moves all announcements to a parent app only. One family does not have a smartphone. They miss a field-trip permission form and their child cannot go. The app solved “fast messages” for many families but created a new problem for others.

**Discuss with a partner or reflect in writing:** Who benefits from the app-only plan? Who is left out? What could the school do differently?

**Do this:** Write **two fair rules** for sharing important school news in more than one way (not only an app).

**Rule 1:**

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**Rule 2:**

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### Part 3 – Access and fairness (about 5 minutes)

The **digital divide** means not everyone has the same access to devices, reliable **Wi-Fi**, language support, or tools that work for **disabilities** (e.g. screen readers, captions). Requiring technology for something that used to work on paper can be unfair if some people cannot use it easily.

**Real-life scenario:** Two students must complete the same online permission form tonight. Maya has a laptop, quiet room, and fast Wi-Fi. Jordan shares one phone with a parent and has spotty data. Both care about school, but Jordan needs much more time for the same task.

**Critical thinking:** Is it fair to require technology for something that used to work on paper? Explain your view in two or three sentences.

**Do this:** Circle **Yes** or **No** for each statement, then explain one choice in a short sentence.

| Statement                                                        | Yes or No? |
|------------------------------------------------------------------|------------|
| Schools should always offer a non-digital way for required forms | _____      |
| It is okay to assume every home has unlimited data               | _____      |
| Captions on videos help more than one group of people            | _____      |

**Why (one sentence):**

Part 4 – New problems and tradeoffs (about 5 minutes)

Technology can **solve** one problem and **create** another. Examples: cameras may increase safety but also make people feel watched; social apps connect friends but can distract from homework; factories automate dull work but may change jobs for workers.

**Real-life scenario:** A school installs more security cameras after items were stolen from lockers. Some students feel safer; others feel they have no private place to relax between classes.

**Discuss with a partner or reflect in writing:** What problem do the cameras solve? What new worry might they cause for some students?

**Do this:** Fill in the table. The first two rows are started for you; add your own in row 3.

| Technology            | Problem it solves         | Possible new concern       |
|-----------------------|---------------------------|----------------------------|
| Homework reminder app | Students forget due dates | Pressure to reply at night |
| Electric buses        | Air pollution from diesel | Cost and charging stations |
|                       |                           |                            |

## Part 5 – Choosing wisely and speaking up (about 5 minutes)

Before adopting a “solution,” ask:

- **Do we need tech for this?**
- **Is there a simpler fix?**
- **Did we ask the people affected?**

**Real-life scenario:** A class group chat replaces study-hall check-in. The teacher wants quick answers, but some students get messages at 10 p.m. and feel they must reply to stay in good standing.

**Discuss with a partner or reflect in writing:** How could the class redesign check-in with kindness and clear boundaries?

**Do this:**

1. **Rewrite** this pushy message in respectful, clear language:

*Original:* “You must install this app tonight or you are not part of the team.”

**Your version:**

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2. **Name one trusted adult** you could talk to if a school “solution” feels unfair or unsafe.

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## Part 6 – Check what you learned (about 2 minutes)

**Checklist.** Put a ✓ in the box when it is true for you.

- ☐ I can explain that technology choices affect different people in different ways.
- ☐ I know why access (devices, Wi-Fi, language, accessibility) matters for fairness.
- ☐ I can describe how a solution can solve one problem and create a new concern.
- ☐ I can ask whether technology is needed and if a simpler fix exists.
- ☐ I can rewrite a message more respectfully and name a trusted adult for help.

When all boxes are checked, you have reviewed the main ideas from this worksheet.